

Checklist:

# Customer Journey Vision

## 1. Define the FOUNDATION

- ☐ Identify the **10x customer outcome** you want to enable.
- ☐ Describe the **actual customer journey** that will generate that outcome.
- ☐ Make sure teams are aligned around the same vision, not just the same metric.
- ☐ Write the vision down so there is a single source of truth.
- ☐ Make the vision bold enough to inspire a meaningful leap, not just a minor improvement.
- ☐ Set a realistic time horizon, usually around **three years**, unless your market or business model requires shorter or longer.
- ☐ Confirm that the vision is ambitious yet achievable with your resources.

## 2. Build the FULL customer JOURNEY

- ☐ Map the journey from the moment the customer realizes they may need a better solution.
- ☐ Include all major stages, not just onboarding or product usage.
- ☐ Describe each stage with enough detail to make the journey plausible.
- ☐ Avoid going so deep that you lock teams into one specific solution too early.
- ☐ Capture the customer's thoughts, emotions, objections, and decision points.

## 3. Cover each journey STAGE

### Trigger

- ☐ Define what causes the customer to realize their current solution is not good enough.
- ☐ Identify whether the trigger is internal, external, or both.
- ☐ Clarify the customer's mental state at the start of the journey.
- ☐ Decide whether your product can create, amplify, or respond to the trigger.

### Discovery

- ☐ Explain how the customer becomes aware your product exists.
- ☐ Identify whether you are competing in a crowded market or creating a new category.
- ☐ Decide what channels, moments, or behaviors will drive discovery.
- ☐ Make sure the customer can connect your product to their desired outcome.

### **Evaluation**

- ☐ Identify what the customer needs to believe before trying the product.
- ☐ List the questions, doubts, or objections they will have.
- ☐ Define what evidence, positioning, or experience helps them continue.
- ☐ Make the product easy to understand quickly.

### **Trial**

- ☐ Define what counts as the customer giving the product a fair shot.
- ☐ Identify what they need to experience during trial to commit.
- ☐ Clarify what “aha moment” or proof point moves them forward.
- ☐ Determine what boxes they need to check before buying, upgrading, or fully adopting.

### **Engagement**

- ☐ Define what meaningful engagement looks like after commitment.
- ☐ Identify the behaviors that help the customer get real value.
- ☐ Make sure customers know which features or actions matter most.
- ☐ Connect engagement behaviors to long-term success.

### **Retention**

- ☐ Identify the moments when customers decide whether to continue.
- ☐ Define what makes customers want to recommit.
- ☐ Confirm customers are actually receiving the expected value.
- ☐ Confirm customers are aware they are receiving that value.
- ☐ Identify events or disappointments that could cause them to switch.

## **4. Ensure competitive differentiation**

- ☐ Study competitors' products and identify weaknesses or gaps.
- ☐ Look at what competitors are not doing, not just what they do poorly.
- ☐ Explore ideas from rapidly changing industries.

- ☐ Identify your unfair advantage and how it could create a superior experience.
- ☐ Observe customer behavior before, during, and after using current solutions.
- ☐ Use bold brainstorming prompts to push beyond obvious solutions.

## 5. Apply the KANO Model

- ☐ Identify **must-haves**: features customers expect and will punish you for missing.
- ☐ Identify **performance features**: areas where more or better directly increases satisfaction.
- ☐ Identify **delighters**: unexpected features that create excitement and word-of-mouth.
- ☐ Decide which features help you compete and which help you stand apart.
- ☐ Revisit these categories over time, because today's delighters can become tomorrow's expectations.

## 6. COMMUNICATE the vision clearly

- ☐ Choose a format people can quickly understand and remember.
- ☐ Avoid relying only on verbal communication.
- ☐ Create artifacts that teams can read, reference, discuss, and update.
- ☐ Make the vision easy for product, design, engineering, sales, and leadership to align around.
- ☐ Use visual or narrative formats when possible.

## 7. Choose vision ARTIFACTS

- ☐ Create a **comic strip** to show the end-to-end customer journey in a simple, human way.
- ☐ Create **vision mock-ups** to show what the future product experience could feel like.
- ☐ Create **customer diary entries** that convey the journey from the customer's perspective.
- ☐ Keep artifacts clear, accessible, and short enough for stakeholders to absorb quickly.
- ☐ Make sure artifacts communicate the whole journey, not just product screens or features.
- ☐ Treat mock-ups as concept direction, not final engineering requirements.

## 8. Add optional SUPPORTING components

- ☐ Define relevant personas.
- ☐ Separate buyer personas from user personas when they are different.
- ☐ Capture each persona's desired outcome, concerns, motivations, and decision criteria.
- ☐ Define design or product principles that guide trade-offs.
- ☐ Use principles to prevent feature creep and keep the product focused.
- ☐ Make sure principles support the customer journey and the competitive differentiation.

## **9. FINAL validation**

- ☐ Can someone outside the team quickly understand the vision?
- ☐ Does the vision explain why the customer would start, continue, and stay?
- ☐ Does it describe the customer's emotional and practical journey?
- ☐ Does it help teams make consistent decisions?
- ☐ Is it bold enough to inspire?
- ☐ Is it grounded enough to be believable?
- ☐ Does it show how the product will deliver the 10x outcome?